

Powers most improved—Coleman '56 rookie

John C. Powers, whom Birmingham fans have seen grow up from a raw sandlotter to the Southern League's leading home run hitter and manufacturer of runs, gets this corner's vote twice.

The first vote is cast for Powers as the most valuable player in the league. The second vote is cast for Powers as the most improved player.



POWERS

J. C. really started his drive for the home run honor when he came here for the Pels' last stand, trailing teammate Emil Panko in homers. It was stated here to watch J. C. go for the honors.

Powers collected nine hits in 20 times at bat, driving in 10 runs. He hit four homers—two of the longest of the year. And he made one of the great throws of the series in taking Blanchard's single and throwing out Brickell trying to score from second.

A year ago Powers was a most pathetic lefthanded hitter against southpaws. "He worked and he worked hard to eliminate his weakness against lefthanders," said Andy Cohen.

And it paid off. J. C. has powdered lefthanders as hard as righthanders in sweeping out front in the home run derby. Every manager who saw Powers last year and this, says he's the most improved player in one year they have ever seen.

Scouts who have trailed Powers all year think he can stick in the majors, if put in the lineup and left alone.

It's close between Gordon Coleman, Mobile, and Emil Panko for the rookie of the year. They have both shown terrific power. Panko has hit more homers than Coleman, but Coleman has driven in more runs.



COLEMAN

Southern League managers describe Coleman as a batter who can hit anything around the plate—a raw rookie but a promising one.

The vote here goes to Coleman, who came off the Duke campus.